

Pairwise Independence of Representation, Classification, and Composition in Finite Extensional Magmas

Stefano Palmieri
Independent Researcher
Austin, Texas, USA

Abstract

Four obstructions jointly narrow the class of finite magmas that can simultaneously represent, classify, and compose with their own operation: nontrivial combinatory algebras with S and K must be infinite; associativity is incompatible with combining a classifier and a retraction pair; commutativity is incompatible with two distinct left-absorbers; and a single left-absorber collapses any classifier. The setting that survives these narrowings is finite, non-associative, non-commutative, extensional 2-pointed magmas.

We identify three operational capabilities of such magmas: self-representation (R), the classifier dichotomy (D), and the Internal Composition Property (H). We prove they are pairwise independent. Lean-verified finite counterexamples at sizes 4 through 10 establish all six non-implications, four with provably tight bounds. A joint irredundance result strengthens this: all eight Boolean combinations of (R, D, H) are realized, so no capability is reducible to a Boolean function of the other two. The minimum coexistence witness has $N=5$, which is optimal: ICP requires 3 pairwise distinct core elements, so $N \geq 5$. The three-category decomposition induced by D is an isomorphism invariant; principal coexistence witnesses are role-rigid (trivial automorphism group); and the ICP is logically equivalent to the standard Compose+Inert axioms. All results are formalized in Lean 4 with zero sorry.

Keywords

finite extensional magma, pairwise independence, classifier dichotomy, internal composition, Lean 4, machine-checked proofs

1 Introduction

A finite magma is the Cayley table of a binary operation, stripped of syntax and types. We study three operational capabilities of such a magma — the operation *representing*, *classifying*, and *composing* with its own structure — and ask whether they are algebraically independent or whether one forces another. These capabilities have been studied abstractly in the reflection literature [1, 3]; our contribution is to pin them down as independent algebraic properties in the finite setting. The formal framework is finite extensional 2-pointed magmas: a finite set with a binary operation, exactly two left-absorbers, and row-extensionality [7].

Four obstructions jointly narrow the candidate class of finite magmas in which all three capabilities can coexist. (i) Nontrivial combinatory algebras with s and k are necessarily infinite (Theorem 3.10), ruling out the most direct finite analogues of PCA/TCA-style [10–12] and Turing-object-style [14] universality. (ii) Associativity is

incompatible with combining a classifier and a retraction pair (Theorem 3.8), excluding semigroups, monoids, groups, and rings. (iii) Commutativity is incompatible with two distinct left-absorbers (Theorem 3.2), forcing the operation to be directed. (iv) A single left-absorber collapses any classifier into itself (Proposition 2.2), forcing at least two absorbers. The setting of this paper — finite, non-associative, non-commutative, extensional 2-pointed magmas — is what survives the four narrowings. Within it, we identify three algebraic properties: self-representation (R), a section-retraction pair on the non-absorber *core*; the classifier dichotomy (D), a clean partition of core elements into those whose action on core lands entirely in the absorbers and those whose action avoids them entirely; and the Internal Composition Property (H), a non-trivial factorization in the left-regular representation restricted to core.

Our main result is that R , D , and H are pairwise independent: no one implies any other. Lean-verified finite counterexamples at sizes $N=4, 5, 6, 8$, and 10 establish all six non-implications; coexistence witnesses at $N=5$ and $N=6$ show all three can hold simultaneously. The $N=5$ bound is optimal: ICP requires 3 pairwise distinct core elements, forcing $|S| \geq 5$. Each counterexample is a concrete Cayley table found by SAT search and independently verified in Lean 4 [9], zero sorry. Whether the independence extends to λ -calculus or typed settings is an open question (Section 9).

Beyond independence, we prove several additional structural results. The no-associativity theorem (Theorem 3.8) rules out the classical algebraic hierarchy: no extensional 2-pointed magma carrying both a classifier and a retraction pair has a right identity or is associative. The three-category decomposition induced by D is an algebraic invariant (Theorem 4.2); the principal coexistence witnesses are *role-rigid* (Proposition 4.6), and at the minimum coexistence size $N=5$ role-rigidity is forced for every $R+D+H$ magma with strong R , while at $N \geq 6$ it is not (Theorem 4.8, Proposition 4.9): a size-driven phase transition in the rigidity of role assignments. The ICP is equivalent to the standard Compose+Inert axioms (Theorem 5.1).

Contributions.

- (1) Four universal algebraic obstructions that jointly narrow the candidate class to the setting: K -infinity (combinatory algebras must be infinite), no-associativity (the classical algebraic hierarchy is excluded), asymmetry (commutativity incompatible with two absorbers), and single-absorber collapse (one absorber collapses any classifier). A schematic classifier-constancy argument further rules out mediality, left/right self-distributivity, and right identity under D or $R+D$ (Section 3, Proposition 2.2).
- (2) An independence theorem: R , D , and H are pairwise independent, with Lean-verified counterexamples in all six directions at $N=4$ through $N=10$ (Section 6), and coexistence witnesses at $N=5$ and $N=6$ (Section 7).

Preprint version. The Lean proofs, SAT search scripts, and manuscript text were developed with assistance from Claude (Anthropic). All results have been independently verified: Lean proofs compile with `lake build` (zero sorry), and SAT counterexamples are frozen in the repository for reproducibility. The author takes full responsibility for all contents.

- (3) An optimal bound: $N = 5$ is the minimum carrier size for $R+D+H$ coexistence. ICP is impossible at $N=4$ by pigeonhole (Theorem 7.1).
- (4) Decomposition invariance and role rigidity: the three-category partition is preserved by isomorphisms (Section 4); the principal coexistence witnesses have trivial automorphism group (Proposition 4.6); role-rigidity is forced at the minimum coexistence size $N=5$ under strong R (Theorem 4.8) but fails at $N \geq 6$ (Proposition 4.9), a size-driven phase transition.
- (5) A characterization of H confirming the ICP is not ad hoc: it is logically equivalent to $\text{Compose}+\text{Inert}$ under variable renaming, with necessity of the non-degeneracy conditions demonstrated by Lean-verified witnesses (Section 5).
- (6) Joint irredundance: all eight cells of the (R, D, H) Boolean cube are inhabited by Lean-verified witnesses (Section 6.1), so no capability is a Boolean function of the other two.

2 Definitions

Throughout, $(S, \cdot)$ is a finite magma on $\text{Fin}(n) = \{0, 1, \dots, n-1\}$ with binary operation $\cdot : \text{Fin}(n) \times \text{Fin}(n) \rightarrow \text{Fin}(n)$.

Definition 2.1 (Extensional 2-Pointed Magma). An *extensional 2-pointed magma* is a tuple $(S, \cdot, z_1, z_2)$ where:

- (1) $z_1, z_2 \in S$ are distinct *left-absorbers*: $z_i \cdot x = z_i$ for all x .
- (2) No other element is a left-absorber.
- (3) *Extensionality*: if $a \cdot x = b \cdot x$ for all x , then $a = b$.

We write $\text{core}(S) := S \setminus \{z_1, z_2\}$ for the non-absorber elements.

Extensionality is the framework’s central commitment: an element’s identity is exhausted by its row in the Cayley table, so two elements that act identically under the operation are the same element. Every subsequent result in this paper depends on this.

The two-absorber requirement is not a parameter choice but a minimality claim. Two is the minimum for the operation to internally register a binary outcome: with a single absorber, there is nowhere for a complementary outcome to land, and the classifier dichotomy (Definition 2.5) cannot be formulated. Proposition 2.2 below makes this precise: extensionality collapses any would-be classifier into the absorber itself. The axioms fix the count at exactly two so that internal classification is forced without adding extraneous constant rows. The axioms do *not*, however, commit to a stronger reading of the two absorbers as “opposites” in any structural sense: the theorems are compatible both with a symmetric reading (two indistinguishable ways the operation fails to discriminate) and a polar reading (two poles of a polarity). This is a genuine freedom in the theory.

PROPOSITION 2.2 (SINGLE-ABSORBER COLLAPSE). *In any extensional magma $(S, \cdot)$ with a left-absorber $z \in S$, if $\tau \in S$ satisfies $\tau \cdot x = z$ for all $x \in S$, then $\tau = z$. Consequently, reading Definition 2.5 with $\{z_1, z_2\}$ replaced by a singleton $\{z\}$ makes the classifier condition unsatisfiable: the requirement $\tau \neq z$ together with $\tau \cdot x \in \{z\}$ for all x has no solution. Two distinct absorbers is the smallest count at which a non-degenerate classifier dichotomy can be formulated.*

PROOF. The rows $x \mapsto \tau \cdot x$ and $x \mapsto z \cdot x$ are both constantly z , so extensionality gives $\tau = z$. The corollary is immediate. Lean: `single_absorber_collapse`. $\square$

Definition 2.3 (Faithful Retract Magma). A *Faithful Retract Magma* (FRM) extends an extensional 2-pointed magma with a *retraction pair* $s, r \in \text{core}(S)$ satisfying $r \cdot (s \cdot x) = x$ for all $x \in \text{core}(S)$, with $r \cdot z_1 = z_1$ (anchoring). The remaining absorber outputs of s and r are unconstrained.

Retraction pair convention. Throughout this paper, the retraction pair (s, r) satisfies the mutual-inverse condition on core : $r \cdot (s \cdot x) = x$ and $s \cdot (r \cdot x) = x$ for all $x \in \text{core}(S)$. This matches the Lean formalization. The choice is load-bearing, not stylistic. One-sided retraction ($r \cdot (s \cdot x) = x$) is a decodable-encoding condition: s produces codes that r can recover. Mutual inverse is the stronger, faithful-representation condition: s and r invert each other in both directions on core , so the encoding neither invents nor loses information. Most theorems (9 of 11) go through under the one-sided hypothesis, and we note this where relevant; two results, retraction pair placement (Theorem 3.5) and the tight bound $|S| \geq 5$ when $s \neq r$ (Theorem 3.6), genuinely require the full mutual inverse. Proposition 2.4 below shows this distinction is non-vacuous: at $N = 4$ there is a concrete one-sided retraction pair with $s \neq r$ that fails mutual inverse, simultaneously confirming that the mutual-inverse hypothesis in Theorem 3.6 cannot be weakened.

PROPOSITION 2.4 (ONE-SIDED / MUTUAL-INVERSE SEPARATION). *There is an extensional 2-pointed magma on $\text{Fin}(4)$ admitting a one-sided retraction pair (s, r) with $s \neq r$, $s, r \in \text{core}$, $r \cdot z_1 = z_1$, and $r \cdot (s \cdot x) = x$ for all $x \in \text{core}$, but no mutual-inverse pair (s', r') with $s' \neq r'$. The explicit Cayley table (rows indexed by the left operand) is:*

$\cdot$	0	1	2	3
0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1
2	1	0	1	3
3	0	2	1	3

with $z_1 = 0, z_2 = 1, s = 2, r = 3$. *Mutual inverse fails at $x = 2$: $s \cdot (r \cdot 2) = 2 \cdot 1 = 0 \neq 2$. Lean: `mutual_strictly_stronger_than_one_sided`.*

PROOF. All axioms (two left-absorbers, extensionality, no other zeros, anchoring, one-sided retraction) are verified by direct inspection of the table; the Lean file discharges each check by decide. The non-existence of a mutual-inverse pair with $s' \neq r'$ is also checked by decide over $\text{Fin}(4) \times \text{Fin}(4)$. The separation establishes two points: (i) mutual inverse strictly implies one-sided retraction, so the axiom choice is substantive; (ii) the one-sided analogue of Theorem 3.6 with $s \neq r$ would admit this $N = 4$ witness, so the bound $|S| \geq 5$ under mutual inverse cannot be weakened to one-sided. $\square$

The retraction pair provides a section/retraction structure on core : s acts as a section and r as a retraction. In finite witnesses this can be used to organize elements into coding schemes, but we do not assume a canonical global encoding.

Definition 2.5 (Classifier Dichotomy). An extensional 2-pointed magma satisfies the *classifier dichotomy* when:

- (1) A classifier $\tau \in \text{core}(S)$ exists with $\tau \cdot x \in \{z_1, z_2\}$ for all x .
- (2) For every $y \in \text{core}(S)$, either
 - $y \cdot x \in \{z_1, z_2\}$ for all $x \in \text{core}(S)$ (y is a *classifier*), or
 - $y \cdot x \notin \{z_1, z_2\}$ for all $x \in \text{core}(S)$ (y is a *non-classifier*).

- (3) At least one non-classifier exists (excluding the degenerate case where the “dichotomy” has only one inhabited class).

The dichotomy creates a three-category decomposition $S = Z \sqcup C \sqcup N$ where $Z = \{z_1, z_2\}$ (absorbers), C (classifiers), and N (non-classifiers). No element can be partially classifying. We call outputs in $\{z_1, z_2\}$ *absorber-valued*.

Definition 2.6 (Internal Composition Property). A magma $(S, \cdot, z_1, z_2)$ satisfies the *Internal Composition Property* (ICP) when:

$\exists a, b, c \in \text{core}(S)$, pairwise distinct, such that:

- (1) *Core-preservation*: $b \cdot x \notin \{z_1, z_2\}$ for all $x \in \text{core}(S)$.
- (2) *Factorization*: $a \cdot x = c \cdot (b \cdot x)$ for all $x \in \text{core}(S)$.
- (3) *Non-triviality*: $|\{a \cdot x : x \in \text{core}(S)\}| \geq 2$.

ICP says: the left-regular representation admits a non-trivial factorization on core. One core action factors through two others, one of them core-preserving: a single fragment of internal composition. Equivalently, the ICP is the point at which the operation contains a pattern of its own use as a resource, with some element’s row visibly the result of composing the operation with itself through another element. In Section 5 we prove that ICP is equivalent to the standard operational axioms *Compose+Inert* (Theorem 5.1).

Definition 2.7 (Capability R). An extensional 2-pointed magma has capability R (self-representation) if it admits a retraction pair.

Definition 2.8 (Capability D). An extensional 2-pointed magma has capability D (self-description) if it satisfies the classifier dichotomy (Definition 2.5: existence of a classifier, the global dichotomy, and non-degeneracy).

Definition 2.9 (Capability H). An extensional 2-pointed magma has capability H (self-execution) if it satisfies the ICP.

All three capabilities are properties of the same base structure (Definition 2.1). None is defined as an extension of any other, making the independence theorem (Section 6) a statement about six non-implications, all proved by Lean-verified counterexamples. The labels “self-representation,” “self-description,” and “self-execution” are heuristic names for the formal properties R , D , and H ; no claim is made that these structures by themselves implement a full internal evaluator.

3 Universal Theorems

The following theorems are proved by pure algebraic reasoning (no decide) and formalized in `CatKripkeWallMinimal.lean` and `NoCommutativity.lean`. We state the hypotheses explicitly: some require only D , while others use both R and D .

3.1 Theorems from D alone

THEOREM 3.1 (THREE-CATEGORY DECOMPOSITION). *In any extensional 2-pointed magma satisfying D , every element is a zero, a classifier, or a non-classifier. The classes are pairwise disjoint: in particular, $C \cap N = \emptyset$ (no element is partially classifying).*

THEOREM 3.2 (ASYMMETRY). *No extensional magma with two distinct left-absorbers is commutative.*

THEOREM 3.3 (NO MEDIALITY). *No extensional 2-pointed magma carrying a classifier is medial: the identity $(a \cdot b) \cdot (c \cdot d) = (a \cdot c) \cdot (b \cdot d)$ cannot hold universally. Setting $a = c = \tau$ and $b = d$ collapses both sides via the classifier-plus-absorber identity, yielding $\tau \cdot b = \tau \cdot \tau$ for all b ; extensionality then forces $\tau \in \{z_1, z_2\}$. Lean: `no_mediality`.*

THEOREM 3.4 (NO RIGHT SELF-DISTRIBUTIVITY). *No extensional 2-pointed magma carrying a classifier satisfies right self-distributivity: the identity $(a \cdot b) \cdot c = (a \cdot c) \cdot (b \cdot c)$ cannot hold universally. The proof instantiates the same pattern as Theorem 3.3: with $a = \tau$, both sides reduce to absorber values under τ ’s classifier property, forcing τ ’s row constant. Lean: `no_right_self_distributivity`.*

3.2 Theorems from R+D

THEOREM 3.5 (RETRACTION PAIR PLACEMENT). *In any extensional 2-pointed magma satisfying both R and D , any witness r to R is a non-classifier: $r \in N$. (Under the stronger mutual-inverse condition in the Lean formalization, $s \in N$ also holds.)*

THEOREM 3.6 (CARDINALITY BOUNDS). $|S| \geq 4$ for any extensional 2-pointed magma satisfying both R and D . (The bound $|S| \geq 4$ is nearly immediate from the definitions, since the four roles (two absorbers, one classifier, one non-classifier) must be distinct; the Lean-verified proof confirms that no subtle interaction reduces it. The bound is tight: a 4-element witness with $s = r$ is exhibited in Appendix A.) Under the stronger mutual-inverse condition with $s \neq r$, $|S| \geq 5$ (also tight); this is the nontrivial bound, as it shows the retraction pair consumes two distinct core slots.

THEOREM 3.7 (NO RIGHT IDENTITY). *No extensional 2-pointed magma satisfying both R and D has a right identity element.*

THEOREM 3.8 (NO ASSOCIATIVITY). *No extensional 2-pointed magma carrying both a classifier and a retraction pair is associative. In particular, no extensional 2-pointed magma satisfying both R and D is a semigroup, monoid, group, or ring: the classifier dichotomy with a retraction pair is incompatible with the entire classical algebraic hierarchy.*

PROOF. Assume $(\tau \cdot a) \cdot b = \tau \cdot (a \cdot b)$ for all a, b . We derive a contradiction in four steps. The proof uses only extensionality, the existence of a classifier τ , and a retraction pair (s, r) . Neither the global dichotomy nor the non-classifier existence axiom is needed. Lean file: `CatKripkeWallMinimal.lean`.

Step 1: τ absorbs on the right. For any a, b :

$$\tau \cdot (a \cdot b) = (\tau \cdot a) \cdot b = z_i \cdot b = z_i = \tau \cdot a$$

where the second equality uses $\tau \cdot a \in \{z_1, z_2\}$ (classifier), and the third uses left-absorption. So $\tau \cdot (a \cdot b) = \tau \cdot a$ for all a, b .

Step 2: τ is constant on core. For any core x : the retraction pair gives $x = r \cdot (s \cdot x)$. Applying Step 1 with $a = r$, $b = s \cdot x$:

$$\tau \cdot x = \tau \cdot (r \cdot (s \cdot x)) = \tau \cdot r.$$

Set $v = \tau \cdot r \in \{z_1, z_2\}$. Then $\tau \cdot x = v$ for all core x .

Step 3: τ is constant on absorbers. Since τ is a classifier, it hits both z_1 and z_2 ; otherwise, if $\tau \cdot x = z_1$ for all x , then τ and z_1 have identical rows, so $\tau = z_1$ by extensionality, contradicting $\tau \neq z_1$ (and symmetrically for z_2). Let b_1, b_2 witness $\tau \cdot b_1 = z_1$ and $\tau \cdot b_2 = z_2$. Applying Step 1 with $a = \tau$:

$$\tau \cdot z_1 = \tau \cdot (\tau \cdot b_1) = \tau \cdot \tau = v, \quad \tau \cdot z_2 = \tau \cdot (\tau \cdot b_2) = \tau \cdot \tau = v.$$

The middle equalities use Step 1; $\tau \cdot \tau = v$ because τ is core (Step 2).

Step 4: Contradiction. Steps 2 and 3 give $\tau \cdot x = v$ for all $x \in S$. Since $v \in \{z_1, z_2\}$, the classifier τ has the same row as absorber v . By extensionality, $\tau = v \in \{z_1, z_2\}$, contradicting $\tau \neq z_1, z_2$. $\square$

Remark 1. The retraction pair is essential in Step 2: the identity $\tau \cdot x = \tau \cdot (r \cdot (s \cdot x)) = \tau \cdot r$ uses $r \cdot (s \cdot x) = x$ to show τ is constant on core. Without a retraction pair, the proof breaks, and the theorem does not extend to “no extensional 2-pointed magma with a classifier is associative.”

THEOREM 3.9 (NO LEFT SELF-DISTRIBUTIVITY). *No extensional 2-pointed magma satisfying both R and D satisfies left self-distributivity: the identity $a \cdot (b \cdot c) = (a \cdot b) \cdot (a \cdot c)$ cannot hold universally. The specialization $a = \tau$ yields $\tau \cdot (b \cdot c) = \tau \cdot b$ (Step 1 of the no-associativity proof); the retraction-pair argument (Steps 2–4) then proceeds identically. Lean: no_left_self_distributivity.*

A single obstruction, not a list of coincidences. Theorems 3.2, 3.3, 3.4, 3.8, and 3.9 share a proof schema: any classical identity whose specialization at $a = \tau$ (or $a = c = \tau$) forces τ ’s row to be constant collides with extensionality, which would then equate τ with an absorber. Commutativity, mediality, and right self-distributivity instantiate the obstruction from D alone; associativity and left self-distributivity use R+D, with the retraction pair extending classifier-constancy from core to absorbers. The classical identities ruled out by R+D are not a list of coincidences but instances of one structural incompatibility: R+D inhabits a specific region of magma space, not merely the complement of associativity.

3.3 The K-infinity obstruction

The following classical result explains why the PCA/TCA framework cannot study finite algebras, and why our setting requires a different combinator basis.

THEOREM 3.10 (K-INFINITY). *If $(A, \cdot, \mathbf{k}, \mathbf{s})$ is a combinatory algebra (total application satisfying $\mathbf{k} \cdot a \cdot b = a$ and the $\mathbf{s}$ equations) with $|A| \geq 2$, then A is infinite.*

PROOF. The map $\varphi(x) = \mathbf{k} \cdot x$ is injective: $\mathbf{k} \cdot a = \mathbf{k} \cdot b$ implies $\mathbf{k} \cdot a \cdot c = \mathbf{k} \cdot b \cdot c$ for all c , hence $a = b$. We claim $\mathbf{k} \notin \text{Im}(\varphi)$. Suppose $\mathbf{k} \cdot x = \mathbf{k}$ for some x . Then for all y , $\mathbf{k} \cdot x \cdot y = \mathbf{k} \cdot y$, so $x = \mathbf{k} \cdot y$ for all y . By injectivity, all y are equal, contradicting $|A| \geq 2$. Thus $\varphi : A \rightarrow A$ is an injection missing $\mathbf{k}$, which is impossible for finite A . $\square$

Remark 2. The proof uses only the $\mathbf{k}$ equation ($\mathbf{k} \cdot a \cdot b = a$) and totality; $\mathbf{s}$ is irrelevant. Our extensional 2-pointed magmas avoid this obstruction: instead of a projector $\mathbf{k}$ with $\mathbf{k} \cdot a \cdot b = a$, they have left-absorbers z with $z \cdot x = z$ (the dual pattern, constant on columns rather than rows) and a retraction pair (s, r) with $r \cdot (s \cdot x) = x$ on core. Neither structure provides a non-surjective injection on the full ground set.

4 Decomposition Invariance

Definition 4.1 (Absorber-Preserving Isomorphism). An absorber-preserving isomorphism $\varphi : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ between extensional 2-pointed magmas is a bijection $\varphi : \text{Fin}(n) \rightarrow \text{Fin}(n)$ satisfying:

- $\varphi(a \cdot_1 b) = \varphi(a) \cdot_2 \varphi(b)$ for all a, b
- $\varphi(z_1^{(1)}) = z_1^{(2)}$ and $\varphi(z_2^{(1)}) = z_2^{(2)}$

THEOREM 4.2 (FUNCTORIALITY). *Any absorber-preserving isomorphism between extensional 2-pointed magmas satisfying D preserves the three-category decomposition: φ maps zeros to zeros, classifiers to classifiers, and non-classifiers to non-classifiers.*

PROOF SKETCH. *Zeros:* if a is a left-absorber, then for all x in the image of φ , $\varphi(a) \cdot_2 \varphi(x) = \varphi(a \cdot_1 x) = \varphi(a)$. By surjectivity, $\varphi(a)$ is a left-absorber.

Classifiers: if $y \cdot_1 x \in \{z_1, z_2\}$ for all core x , then $\varphi(y) \cdot_2 \varphi(x) = \varphi(y \cdot_1 x) \in \{z_1', z_2'\}$ for all core $\varphi(x)$. By surjectivity and injectivity (to exclude absorber preimages), $\varphi(y)$ is a classifier.

Non-classifiers: symmetric argument using injectivity to transport $\notin \{z_1, z_2\}$.

Algebraic proof (no decide); Lean file: Functoriality.lean. $\square$

COROLLARY 4.3 (CANONICITY OF THE DECOMPOSITION). *The $Z/C/N$ partition is the unique coarsest non-trivial isomorphism-invariant partition of the core. Any absorber-preserving isomorphism preserves each class individually (Theorem 4.2), so no coarser partition of core into two non-empty parts can be invariant unless it coincides with C/N . The classification is determined by a single algebraic invariant: whether an element’s row on core has image contained in $\{z_1, z_2\}$.*

THEOREM 4.4 (CAPABILITY INVARIANCE). *All three capabilities R, D, and H are preserved by absorber-preserving isomorphisms of extensional 2-pointed magmas. If $\varphi : M_1 \rightarrow M_2$ is an absorber-preserving isomorphism and M_1 satisfies R (resp. D, H), then M_2 satisfies R (resp. D, H). The three capabilities are intrinsic algebraic properties, not presentation artifacts.*

PROOF. R: if (s, r) is a retraction pair in M_1 , then $(\varphi(s), \varphi(r))$ is a retraction pair in M_2 . The mutual-inverse equations transport through the homomorphism, and anchoring ($r \cdot z_1 = z_1$) transfers by zero-preservation.

D: the classifier $\varphi(\tau)$ is absorber-valued in M_2 (by the homomorphism and zero-preservation). The global dichotomy transfers by surjectivity: every element in M_2 has a preimage whose dichotomy status transports. Non-degeneracy transfers by injectivity.

H: the ICP triple $(\varphi(a), \varphi(b), \varphi(c))$ satisfies the factorization equation in M_2 . Injectivity preserves pairwise-distinctness and non-triviality; surjectivity preserves core-preservation.

Algebraic proofs (no decide); Lean file: CapabilityInvariance.lean. $\square$

4.1 Role Rigidity

Corollary 4.3 fixes *role classes*: Z , C , and N are intrinsic invariants of the Cayley table. Individual role assignments within each class — which absorber is z_1 , which classifier is τ , which core element is the section s versus the retraction r — remain, in general, determined only up to $\text{Aut}(M)$.

Definition 4.5 (Role-Rigid Magma). A magma $(S, \cdot)$ is *role-rigid* if the only operation-preserving bijection $\sigma : S \rightarrow S$ is the identity — equivalently, $\text{Aut}(M)$ is trivial. In a role-rigid magma every element is fixed by every automorphism, so individual role assignments are $\text{Aut}(M)$ -invariants of the Cayley table, not artifacts of presentation.

PROPOSITION 4.6 (RIGIDITY OF PRINCIPAL WITNESSES). *The following paper witnesses are role-rigid:*

- the $N=5$ R+D+H coexistence witness (dotW5);
- the $N=6$ R+D+H coexistence witness (dotW6);
- the $N=4$ R+D witness (dotK4);
- the $N=5$ R+D witness with $s \neq r$ (dotK5);
- the $N=4$ one-sided separator of Proposition 2.4 (dotOSS).

Each is discharged by native_decide over $\text{Equiv.Perm}(\text{Fin}(n))$ in `Rigidity.lean`.

COROLLARY 4.7 (POLAR ABSORBERS IN ROLE-RIGID MAGMAS). *In a role-rigid magma, no automorphism exchanges the two absorbers: z_1 and z_2 lie in distinct $\text{Aut}(M)$ -orbits. The polar reading of the absorber pair (two distinguishable outcomes) is therefore forced; the symmetric reading (an involution swapping the pair) is incompatible with role rigidity. Lean: `role_rigid_polar_absorbers`.*

Syntax into semantics. Role rigidity extends the reach of extensionality. Extensionality already collapses identity-level syntax into semantics: two elements with equal rows are the same element. Role rigidity collapses role-level syntax: each label assignment (which element plays z_1 , which plays τ , which plays s versus r) is forced by algebraic invariants computable from the Cayley table, not supplied by external choice. In a role-rigid magma, every presentation commitment is an algebraic consequence of the operation.

Rigidity under capability-density scaling. Role-rigidity of the principal witnesses (Proposition 4.6) is not a uniform consequence of R+D+H. A brute-force automorphism computation on all witnesses finds $|\text{Aut}(M)| = 1$ in every case at $N \geq 4$; the two $N = 3$ witnesses `frm3` (R only) and `cell8` (no capability) admit a non-trivial absorber-swapping involution. But past the minimum coexistence size the uniformity breaks down:

THEOREM 4.8 ($N = 5$ RIGIDITY UNDER STRONG R, Z3-VERIFIED). *Every extensional 2-pointed magma on $\text{Fin}(5)$ satisfying R with a mutual-inverse retraction pair (s, r) with $s \neq r$, D, and H is role-rigid. Z3-verified UNSAT in 0.6 seconds; independent brute-force Python confirmation (enumerating all 120 permutations of $\text{Fin}(5)$ per candidate) agrees. Script: `scripts/rigidity_search_N5_strongR.py`; UNSAT certificate: `scripts/rigidity_search_N5_strongR_result.txt`. A machine-checked Lean proof of this statement is open (Section 9, Open Problem 4): Lean’s default Decidable synthesis does not route through the outer universal over $\text{Fin}(5) \rightarrow \text{Fin}(5) \rightarrow \text{Fin}(5)$; a structured case split or custom decidability instance would close this.*

PROPOSITION 4.9 (NON-RIGIDITY AT $N \geq 6$ UNDER STRONG R). *At $N = 6, 7, 8$ there exist finite extensional 2-pointed magmas satisfying R (mutual-inverse with $s \neq r$), D, and H with non-trivial automorphism group. Sizes and orbit structures:*

- $N = 6$: $|\text{Aut}(M)| = 6$ (the symmetric group S_3), permuting three identity-on-core non-classifiers that differ only at the z_2 column. The classifier has constant row on core, a degenerate classification.
- $N = 7$: $|\text{Aut}(M)| = 2$, with one involution permuting a classifier pair and a non-classifier pair.
- $N = 8$: $|\text{Aut}(M)| = 4$, including an absorber-swap automorphism. Corollary 4.7 (polar absorbers) therefore fails for R+D+H under strong R alone at this size.

Z3 scripts and witness JSONs: `scripts/rigidity_search_strongR.py`, `scripts/nonrigid_rdh_N{6,7,8}_strongR.json`. Each is independently verified by Python brute-force.

The contrast is sharp: at the minimum coexistence size $N = 5$ the constraints of R+D+H with $s \neq r$ are tight enough to force role-rigidity as a theorem, while one step larger ($N = 6$) it fails. This is a genuine phase transition in the axiom system — role-rigidity is size-driven at the frontier where coexistence first becomes possible, and additional structural constraints are required to propagate it to larger sizes. The two counterexamples exhibit distinct structural pathologies: at $N = 6$, classifier-core-constancy (τ ’s row on core hits only one absorber value); at $N = 8$, classifier-pair boundary-indistinguishability (two classifiers agreeing on both absorber inputs). Each suggests a candidate additional axiom (classifier-nontriviality on core; classifier boundary-discrimination) that would rule out its respective counterexample.

5 ICP Characterization

An algebra with R can encode, decode, and look up any entry in the Cayley table via the retraction pair (s, r) . But this requires an external machine to supply control flow: dispatch, composition, recursion. H internalizes a non-trivial composition pattern that would otherwise be supplied externally: dedicated elements whose left-multiplication implements composition ($\eta = \rho \circ g$) and storage (g). The ICP captures exactly this: one core action factors through two others, meaning the algebra contains a fragment of its own control flow as an element.

The standard formulation uses two operational axioms:

- *Compose*: $\eta \cdot x = \rho \cdot (g \cdot x)$ for all $x \in \text{core}(S)$
- *Inert*: $g \cdot x \notin \{z_1, z_2\}$ for all $x \in \text{core}(S)$

with η, g, ρ pairwise distinct non-absorbers and η non-trivial (≥ 2 distinct values on core).

THEOREM 5.1 (ICP EQUIVALENCE). *For any finite magma on a 2-pointed set $(S, \cdot, z_1, z_2)$ of any size n :*

$$\text{ICP} \iff \text{Compose} + \text{Inert} \text{ (with non-trivial composite).}$$

PROOF. The bijection between witness triples is $(\eta, g, \rho) = (a, b, c)$: the composed element a is η , the core-preserving element b is g , and the outer element c is ρ . Under this identification the factorization $a \cdot x = c \cdot (b \cdot x)$ becomes $\eta \cdot x = \rho \cdot (g \cdot x)$ (Compose), core-preservation of b becomes Inert, and the remaining conditions (pairwise distinct, non-absorber) transfer directly.

The pairwise-distinctness and non-triviality conditions are not cosmetic; they block two degeneracies, and both are proved necessary by Lean-verified witnesses (ICP.lean). Without pairwise-distinctness, the retraction pair (s, r) with $s = r$ trivially satisfies factorization via $s \cdot x = s \cdot (s \cdot x)$, giving every FRM a spurious ICP; the minimal R+D model at $N = 4$ (Cayley table in Appendix A; Lean name `kr ipke4`) separates the weakened definition from the full one (theorem `icp_distinct_necessary`). Without non-triviality, any constant-on-core element a (with $a \cdot x = v$ for all core x) trivially factors through any core-preserving b by taking c with $c \cdot y = v$; a custom 6-element FRM separates the weakened definition from the full one (theorem `icp_nontrivial_necessary`, ICP.lean).

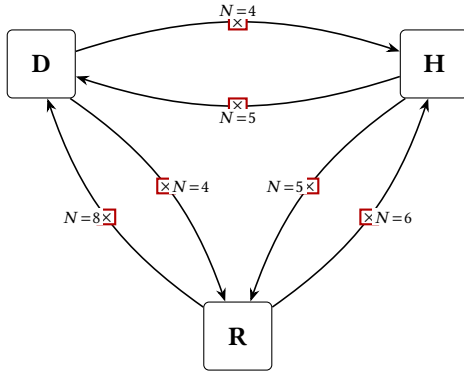


Figure 1: Full independence structure. All six pairwise non-implications are proved by Lean-verified finite counterexamples at the indicated sizes. No capability implies any other.

The proof is pure equational logic, with no decide, no case analysis on n . It holds for every finite magma on a 2-pointed set, of any size. Lean file: `ICP.lean`, theorem `icp_iff_composeInert`. $\square$

This equivalence gives H a single-concept definition: the left-regular representation contains a non-trivially composed element. The operational axioms (Compose, Inert) and the ICP are the same property under variable renaming. Additionally, ICP is invariant under FRM isomorphisms (algebraic proof, no decide; `ICP.lean`, theorem `FRMiso.preserves_icp`).

6 Independence

THEOREM 6.1 (FULL INDEPENDENCE). *No capability implies any other. Specifically, all six pairwise non-implications hold:*

- (1) $R \Rightarrow D$: An extensional 2-pointed magma of size 8 satisfying R contains a classifier element but fails the global dichotomy condition.
- (2) $R \Rightarrow H$: An extensional 2-pointed magma of size 6 satisfying R has 4 core elements (enough for ICP to be non-vacuous) but no triple satisfies the ICP.
- (3) $D \Rightarrow H$: An extensional 2-pointed magma of size 4 satisfying D has only 2 core elements, so ICP is vacuously unsatisfiable (pigeonhole).
- (4) $H \Rightarrow D$: An extensional 2-pointed magma of size 5 satisfies ICP but violates the classifier dichotomy. This is tight: ICP requires $N \geq 5$.
- (5) $D \Rightarrow R$: An extensional 2-pointed magma of size 4 satisfies the classifier dichotomy but admits no retraction pair. This is tight: D requires $N \geq 4$.
- (6) $H \Rightarrow R$: An extensional 2-pointed magma of size 5 satisfies ICP but admits no retraction pair. This is tight: ICP requires $N \geq 5$.

PROOF. Each direction is proved by exhibiting a concrete Cayley table and verifying the claimed properties by `native_decide` (or `decide` for $N \leq 8$). The tables are:

$R \Rightarrow D$ ($N=8$). An 8×8 Cayley table (Appendix A) defining an FRM with $s=2$, $r=3$. Element 4 is a classifier, but element 5's

row on core is $(6, 2, 1, 1, 1, 1)$, mixing absorber and non-absorber outputs, violating the dichotomy. SAT confirms the non-implication is achievable as early as $N=3$, but vacuously: with only 1 core element, the dichotomy cannot be formulated (it requires both a classifier and a non-classifier). The $N=8$ witness is the smallest with enough core structure for D to be non-vacuously falsifiable. Lean file: `Countermodel.lean`.

$R \Rightarrow H$ ($N=6$, structural). A 6×6 Cayley table (Appendix A) defining an extensional 2-pointed magma with a retraction pair ($s=r=2$, an involution on core) but no ICP. The core has 4 elements, more than the 3 pairwise distinct witnesses ICP requires, yet no triple satisfies the ICP. As with $R \Rightarrow D$, the non-implication is vacuously achievable at $N=3$ (only 1 core element), but the $N=6$ witness is the smallest where ICP failure is structural rather than dimensional. Lean file: `E2PM.lean`, theorem `s_not_implies_icp_structural`.

$D \Rightarrow H$ ($N=4$, tight). The minimal $R+D$ model at $N=4$ (kripke4 in Appendix A) has only 2 core elements. ICP requires 3 pairwise distinct non-absorbers, so it is vacuously unsatisfiable. Lean file: `ICP.lean`, theorem `kripke4_no_icp`. The $N=10$ $D+R$ model in `Countermodels10.lean` complements this: it has 8 core elements (more than enough for ICP to be non-vacuous), yet no triple satisfies ICP. The formal non-implication holds at $N=4$; the $N=10$ witness shows it persists even when H has room to exist.

$H \Rightarrow D$ ($N=5$, tight). A 5×5 Cayley table satisfying ICP but with no classifier: all three core elements map core to core (no element produces only absorber-valued outputs on core). The bound is tight: ICP requires $N \geq 5$. Lean file: `E2PM.lean`, theorem `h_not_implies_d_tight`.

$D \Rightarrow R$ ($N=4$, tight). A 4×4 Cayley table with the classifier dichotomy (classifier at index 2, non-classifier at index 3) but no retraction pair among the 4 possible assignments from core. The bound is tight: D requires $N \geq 4$. Lean file: `E2PM.lean`, theorem `d_not_implies_s_tight`.

$H \Rightarrow R$ ($N=5$, tight). A 5×5 Cayley table satisfying ICP but admitting no retraction pair. The bound is tight: ICP requires $N \geq 5$. Lean file: `E2PM.lean`, theorem `h_not_implies_s_tight`.

All tables are generated by Z3 SAT solver and independently verified. The Cayley tables are frozen in the repository for reproducibility. $\square$

Methodology and minimality. Each counterexample was found by encoding the relevant capability axioms (and the negation of the target capability) as a SAT problem over an $n \times n$ Cayley table, then solving with Z3, incrementing n from 3 upward. Once found, each table was frozen and independently verified in Lean. Four of six directions have provably tight bounds: $D \Rightarrow R$ and $D \Rightarrow H$ are tight at $N=4$ (the minimum where D is non-vacuous, resp. where ICP is dimensionally impossible); $H \Rightarrow R$ and $H \Rightarrow D$ are tight at $N=5$ (the minimum where ICP can be stated). The remaining two ($R \Rightarrow D$ at $N=8$, $R \Rightarrow H$ at $N=6$) are the smallest non-vacuous witnesses found. The SAT search was exhaustive: all smaller sizes returned UNSAT for every role assignment tested. Whether different role assignments or overlapping encodings could yield tighter witnesses is open.

Scaling. The independence is not a small-size artifact. SAT search confirms that all six non-implications are satisfiable at every size from their respective minima through $N=15$ (the solver limit). No size was found where any direction becomes UNSAT. Whether the independence holds at all sizes (for all $n \geq 5$, there exist witnesses at size n for each direction) is a natural conjecture supported by this data.

Interpretation. The independence result shows that R , D , and H are genuinely three things, not one. An algebra can encode and decode without classifying (R without D). An algebra can classify without encoding (D without R). An algebra can internally compose without classifying or encoding (H without R or D). No capability algebraically forces any other. In particular, the $H \Rightarrow D$ direction shows that an algebra can internalize a non-trivial composition pattern without satisfying the classifier dichotomy: internal composition does not force organizational separation.

6.1 Joint irredundance: the Boolean cube

Pairwise independence shows no capability implies any other. A stronger form of irredundance asks whether some capability is a *Boolean function* of the other two: if R were equivalent to $D \wedge \neg H$, say, the triple (R, D, H) would collapse to the pair (D, H) . We rule this out by exhibiting a witness in each of the eight cells of the (R, D, H) Boolean cube.

THEOREM 6.2 (JOINT IRREDUNDANCE). *Each of the eight Boolean combinations of (R, D, H) is realized by a Lean-verified finite extensional 2-pointed magma.*

Cell	Profile	N	Witness
1	$R \wedge D \wedge H$	5	witness5
2	$R \wedge D \wedge \neg H$	4	kripke4
3	$R \wedge \neg D \wedge H$	10	hNotD
4	$R \wedge \neg D \wedge \neg H$	3	frm3 (new)
5	$\neg R \wedge D \wedge H$	5	cell15 (new)
6	$\neg R \wedge D \wedge \neg H$	4	dNoS4
7	$\neg R \wedge \neg D \wedge H$	5	hNoD5
8	$\neg R \wedge \neg D \wedge \neg H$	3	cell18 (new)

Five cells are populated by witnesses that already appear in the pairwise-independence proof, after adding the missing capability annotations. Three required fresh constructions: cell 4 and cell 8 are minimal ($N=3$) FRM and E2PM witnessing “ R alone” and “no capability” respectively; cell 5 (D and H without R) is the cube’s most structurally constrained corner, an $N=5$ magma with two classifiers, one core-preserving non-classifier serving as the ICP’s b , and no retraction pair. All verifications are machine-checked by `decide` or `native_decide` in `BooleanCube.lean`.

The cell sizes reveal an asymmetry: every cell containing H requires $N \geq 5$, while cells with only R and/or D are realized at $N=3$ or 4. H carries strictly more structural weight than R or D , consistent with the row-scarcity argument in Section 9: ICP’s factorization demand $a \cdot x = c \cdot (b \cdot x)$ constrains three rows simultaneously and requires three pairwise-distinct core elements, which R and D do not.

Consequence. If any capability were Boolean-equivalent to a combination of the other two, some cell would be empty. All cells are inhabited: no reduction of three predicates to two exists. R , D ,

and H therefore carry mutually irreducible information — jointly irredundant, not merely pairwise independent.

7 Coexistence

THEOREM 7.1 (NO ICP AT $N=4$). *No extensional 2-pointed magma of size 4 satisfies the ICP. The core $\{2, 3\}$ has only 2 elements, but ICP requires 3 pairwise distinct non-absorbers. Lean: `Witness5.lean`, `no_icp_at_4`.*

THEOREM 7.2 (COEXISTENCE WITNESS). *The three capabilities R , D , and H are simultaneously satisfiable. A Lean-verified witness exists at $N=5$, which is optimal by Theorem 7.1.*

PROOF. A concrete 5×5 Cayley table is exhibited with $s=r=2$ (identity on core), classifiers $\tau \in \{3, 4\}$, and ICP witnessed by $a=3, b=2, c=4$. The retraction pair collapses to a single element ($s=r$) which doubles as the ICP’s core-preserving map; since b is the identity, the factorization $a \cdot x = c \cdot (b \cdot x)$ reduces to $a \cdot x = c \cdot x$ on core, yielding two classifiers that agree on core but distinguished by their absorber columns. The lower bound is pigeonhole: at $N=4$, the core $\{2, 3\}$ has only 2 elements, but ICP requires 3 pairwise distinct non-absorbers (`no_icp_at_4`). Lean file: `Witness5.lean`, `theorem sdh_witness_5`. A 6×6 witness with $s \neq r$ is also verified (`Witness6.lean`). $\square$

PROPOSITION 7.3 (SEPARATED-ROLE WITNESS). *There is a witness at $N=10$ in which the principal $R+D+H$ roles (2 absorbers, 2 retraction pair, 1 classifier, 3 ICP witnesses) occupy 8 distinct elements.*

PROOF. A concrete 10×10 Cayley table (Appendix A) satisfies all three capabilities with distinct role assignments. Lean file: `Witness10.lean`. A witness with $s \neq r$ (non-degenerate retraction) is exhibited at $N=6$ (Appendix A). $\square$

Minimum cardinality. $N=5$ is the optimal minimum for $R+D+H$ coexistence (Lean-verified; `Witness5.lean`). The witness uses $s=r$ (identity on core), two classifiers, and one non-classifier: the retraction pair member doubles as the ICP’s core-preserving element. At $N=4$ the core has only 2 elements but ICP requires 3 pairwise distinct non-absorbers, so $N=4$ is impossible (`no_icp_at_4`).

The $N=5$ witness reveals how thin the three properties can become simultaneously. The retraction pair is the identity on core ($s=r$, no actual encoding work), and the ICP factorization $a \cdot x = c \cdot (b \cdot x)$ collapses to $a \cdot x = c \cdot x$ (row equality on core between two classifiers differing only on absorber columns). The three capabilities are formally present but barely interacting. The $N=6$ witness with $s \neq r$ (`Witness6.lean`) is the more informative example: the retraction pair does genuine encoding, the ICP factorization is non-degenerate, and the roles do not trivially overlap. We retain the general definitions (allowing $s=r$) since the algebraic results (independence, injectivity, no-associativity) hold regardless.

8 Related Work

Partial and total combinatory algebras. PCAs [10, 11] and TCAs [12] provide the standard algebraic framework for realizability and computability. PCA theory has a rich structural theory: morphisms between PCAs, the lattice of PCA quotients, and totalizability [13] all involve detailed analysis of the application operation. PCA theory does study which elements realize which functions. However,

this analysis concerns representability and inter-PCA relationships, not the *partition* of elements into behavioral types by their row structure. This question requires a finite total operation table to formulate; it does not arise in the PCA/TCA setting, where application is partial or the carrier is infinite. Bethke and Klop [13] proved that some PCAs cannot be extended to total ones, a structural result about the relationship between partiality and totality. The K-infinity theorem (our Theorem 3.10) shows that nontrivial S+K algebras must be infinite, explaining why finite algebras fall outside this framework and why our setting requires a different combinator basis.

Turing categories. Cockett and Hofstra [14] define a Turing category as a cartesian restriction category with a Turing object A and a Turing morphism $\bullet : A \times A \rightarrow A$ that universally simulates all morphisms in the category. The Structure Theorem establishes that PCAs and Turing categories are two views of the same concept. Turing objects have cardinality “one or infinite” [14], ruling out nontrivial finite Turing objects. The Turing morphism is described as “the heart of the whole structure” but its algebraic properties (row structure, element classification, associativity constraints) are not studied. Where Turing categories distribute computational roles across distinct objects (programs, data, evaluators), our finite algebras develop the same roles internally as emergent behavioral regions within a single carrier set: absorbers encode failure, classifiers provide absorber-valued judgment, and the retraction pair provides encoding.

Self-interpretation. Mogensen [2] constructs self-interpreters for the λ -calculus. Brown and Palsberg [3] show that self-interpretation is possible in strongly-normalizing typed languages, contradicting earlier impossibility results. These works study self-interpretation (our R) but do not address the independence of R from D or H.

Independence in finite algebra. Independence and non-implication results between equational properties have a long history in universal algebra, from Birkhoff’s characterization of equational classes [7] to Mal’cev conditions characterizing implications between properties of varieties. Our results operate at a different level: we separate *operational* properties (retraction pairs, classifier partitions, factorizations in the left-regular representation) rather than equational identities, and our base class, the finite extensional 2-pointed magmas, is not a variety in the Birkhoff sense (extensionality is a quasi-identity, not an equation). To our knowledge, the pairwise independence of retraction pairs, classifier dichotomies, and factorization properties in finite magmas has not been previously established. The SAT-find-then-Lean-verify methodology is related to the use of automated tools such as Mace4 [8] for counterexample search in algebra, though we use Z3 for constraint solving and Lean 4 for independent formal verification.

Finite model theory and machine-checked proofs. Independence results via finite counterexamples are standard in finite model theory [6]. Each Cayley table is frozen in the Lean source and verified by the kernel, eliminating transcription errors. The sizes involved ($N=5$ through $N=10$) are small enough for `decide/native_decide` but large enough that hand-verification of all conditions would be error-prone. The universal algebraic theorems (no-associativity,

decomposition invariance, ICP equivalence) are proved by pure equational reasoning without `decide`, and hold for all finite sizes.

9 Discussion

The classifier dichotomy is organizational. D organizes elements into coherent categories: classifiers that test and non-classifiers that transform. The $H \Rightarrow D$ result shows that an algebra can internalize composition without this organization. D contributes semantic structure rather than compositional behavior.

Why magmas? Magmas are not a limitation but a natural choice, for two independent reasons. First, the K-infinity theorem (Theorem 3.10) shows that nontrivial combinatory algebras with s and k must be infinite: the k combinator is a non-surjective injection on any finite set with ≥ 2 elements. Finite self-description requires a different combinator basis, one without a K-like projector, and our extensional 2-pointed magmas provide exactly this. Second, Theorem 3.8 shows that associativity forces any classifier to have a constant row, collapsing it to an absorber. Combined with the no-right-identity result (Theorem 3.7), this independently rules out the entire classical algebraic hierarchy: no semigroup, monoid, group, or ring can support the classifier dichotomy alongside a retraction pair. Self-description lives outside both the PCA/TCA framework (by cardinality) and the classical algebraic hierarchy (by associativity). This connects to the broader observation that reflective systems are inherently non-associative: λ -calculus application is non-associative ($((fg)x \neq f(gx)$ in general). The no-associativity theorem shows this is algebraically forced, not a design accident.

Finiteness is essential, not merely technical. Finiteness plays two roles in this paper. Technically, it makes `decide` and `native_decide` applicable to the counterexamples. Substantively, it underwrites the K-infinity obstruction (Theorem 3.10) and the row-scarcity argument behind the independence of D and H (below): the structures studied here are those whose self-description is of a completed totality, with a bounded supply of rows. On infinite carriers that constraint dissolves and the independence need not transfer; extending it beyond the finite setting is a separate question about a structurally different phenomenon.

The role of extensionality. Extensionality (distinct elements have distinct rows) is load-bearing throughout. Without it, the no-associativity proof fails: Step 4 derives $\tau = v$ from identical rows. Without it, any constant-row element trivially satisfies both classifier and non-classifier conditions, making the three-category decomposition degenerate. Extensionality is not merely a convenience but the condition that makes element-level classification meaningful. An element’s identity is its row in the Cayley table; extensionality formalizes this.

Why these three properties? Extensionality identifies each element with its row in the Cayley table. The elements of a finite extensional 2-pointed magma are therefore a family of typed maps $\{L_a^{\text{core}} : \text{core} \rightarrow \text{core} \cup Z\}$, one per element, with the absorber maps L_{z_1}, L_{z_2} being constant. R, D, and H correspond to the three fundamental structural questions about such a family:

- *Splitting* (R): does the identity on core split through the family? That is, do some L_s, L_r satisfy $L_r \circ L_s = \text{id}_{\text{core}}$? This is a section-retraction pair [4].
- *Codomain purity* (D): does each map hit core or Z , never both? This is the unique coarsest non-trivial isomorphism-invariant partition of core (Corollary 4.3).
- *Factorization* (H): does the family contain a non-trivial composition, $L_a = L_c \circ L_b$ with L_b core-preserving and L_a non-constant? This is the weakest factorization condition that is not vacuously satisfiable: weakening either the pairwise-distinctness or the non-triviality requirement makes every retraction-equipped magma satisfy it trivially (Lean-verified separations in ICP.lean).

Each property is minimal in its own sense. R is the standard notion of splitting. D is the coarsest invariant partition. H is the weakest non-degenerate factorization. The independence and joint-irredundance results (Theorems 6.1, 6.2) confirm these are three questions jointly irredundant, not reducible to two. The precise categorical status of D and H is discussed further in the categorical connections paragraph below; whether either corresponds to a known universal property remains open.

Minimality of the kernel. We conjecture, but do not prove, that R, D, and H constitute a minimal kernel for self-description in finite extensional 2-pointed magmas: no weaker combination captures internal encoding, classification, and a non-trivial composition fragment jointly. Theorem 6.2 establishes a weak form of this conjecture: no capability is a Boolean function of the other two, so the triple cannot be compressed to a pair under any Boolean reduction. The stronger claim — that no genuinely weaker notion (Boolean or otherwise) captures the same territory — remains open. Supporting evidence includes the independence theorem (none of the three is derivable from the others) and the no-associativity obstruction (Theorem 3.8, which shows that collapsing composition into classification destroys the classifier). A proof of the stronger form, or a counterexample exhibiting a strictly smaller sufficient kernel, is open.

Categorical connections and their limits. Several constructions in this paper have natural categorical readings. The core $\text{core}(S)$ is a retract of the carrier via (s, r) , in the standard sense of [4]. The three-category decomposition defines a functor from the category **E2PM** (extensional 2-pointed magmas with absorber-preserving homomorphisms) to the category of three-block set partitions: Theorems 4.2 and 4.4 establish that both the decomposition and the three capabilities are preserved by morphisms. The classifier dichotomy is a codomain-purity condition on the family of left-multiplication maps $\{L_a^{\text{core}} : \text{core} \rightarrow \text{core} \cup Z\}$, partitioning them by image type.

The categorical analogy breaks down at composition. The left-multiplication maps L_a^{core} are not closed under composition: $L_a \circ L_b$ need not equal L_c for any element c . For instance, in the $N = 5$ coexistence witness, $L_2 \circ L_3$ on core gives $(0, 2, 0)$, which is not the core row of any element. This means the row family does not form a transformation monoid, and standard categorical constructions (internal hom, enrichment, Turing morphism) cannot be stated internally. The no-associativity theorem (Theorem 3.8) predicts this

failure: associativity of the magma operation would be a prerequisite for the left-multiplication maps to form a monoid, and the theorem shows associativity is incompatible with the R+D structure. The composition-closure failure is not a gap in the formalization but a consequence of the same obstruction that motivates the setting.

Why the independence holds. The independence of D and H reflects incompatible row constraints under finiteness. A classifier's row is fully committed to absorber values on core: every core input maps to z_1 or z_2 . An ICP witness a requires $a \cdot x = c \cdot (b \cdot x)$ with at least two distinct values on core, so its row must be non-trivially structured. These demands are incompatible for any single element, so different elements must carry these roles. The independence holds because finiteness limits the total supply of elements and constrains which row patterns can coexist under extensionality. The $H \not\Rightarrow D$ direction has the same character: an ICP triple (a, b, c) constrains three rows to satisfy a factorization equation, but this imposes no absorber-output condition on any fourth element.

The infinite boundary. In infinite carriers where the set of left-multiplication maps is unconstrained, such as the full function space over a countable set, the row-scarcity constraint dissolves. The carrier is large enough to accommodate elements with arbitrary row patterns, and the tension between classifier rows and factorization rows need not arise. Whether the independence survives in specific infinite algebraic settings is open. This is an observation about resource limitations, not a theorem about Turing completeness: the precise conditions under which the independence transfers require defining the relevant algebraic properties for infinite carriers, which is beyond this paper's scope.

R as a separate design choice. The independence of R from D and H plausibly extends beyond finite magmas. A faithful internal encoding, a section-retraction pair on the carrier, is a separate design choice from classification or composition. Mogensen's self-interpreter for the λ -calculus [2] requires an explicit quoting convention; without it, the calculus is computationally universal but lacks internal self-representation. This suggests that the R-independence is not an artifact of finiteness but reflects a genuine structural distinction between having computational capabilities and having a faithful encoding of one's own elements as data.

Scope and limitations. Whether the three-capability separation appears in other settings (λ -calculus, typed systems, infinite algebras) is the primary open question. Theorem 3.8 constrains the target: any such translation must work without associativity or identity. Each capability admits multiple axiom forms; the independence result holds for all variants. The independence also implies that any system combining all three capabilities must introduce additional axioms beyond R, D, and H to connect them; the nature of these connecting axioms is a natural direction for further work.

10 Conclusion

Four obstructions — K-infinity, no-associativity, asymmetry, and single-absorber collapse — jointly narrow the candidate class of finite magmas that can carry the operational capabilities of representation, classification, and composition down to the setting of this paper: finite, non-associative, non-commutative, extensional

2-pointed magmas. Within it, we have identified three natural algebraic properties, self-representation (R), the classifier dichotomy (D), and the Internal Composition Property (H), and proved they are pairwise independent. The six non-implications are machine-checked in Lean 4. Joint irredundance strengthens this: all eight Boolean combinations of (R, D, H) are realized (Theorem 6.2), so no capability is a Boolean function of the other two. The optimal coexistence witness has $N=5$ (Theorem 7.2). The three-category decomposition induced by D is a functorial invariant (Theorem 4.2); the principal coexistence witnesses are role-rigid (Proposition 4.6), with role-rigidity forced at $N=5$ and failing at $N \geq 6$ under strong R (Theorem 4.8, Proposition 4.9); and the ICP is logically equivalent to Compose+Inert (Theorem 5.1). All results are formalized in Lean 4 (zero sorry).

Open problems.

- (1) *Cross-formalism universality*: Does the three-capability separation appear in the λ -calculus, typed settings, or infinite algebras? The no-associativity obstruction (Theorem 3.8) constrains the target setting.
- (2) *Categorical characterization of H*: The ICP is the weakest non-degenerate factorization property of the left-regular representation (weakening either pairwise-distinctness or non-triviality makes it vacuous). Is it equivalent to a standard universal property (e.g., existence of a partial internal hom)?
- (3) *Categorical characterization of D*: D is the unique coarsest non-trivial isomorphism-invariant partition of core (Corollary 4.3), isolating the two-valued aspect of a subobject classifier without the universality aspect. The left-multiplication maps lack composition closure, precluding standard categorical formulations. Does D correspond to a known concept in non-associative categorical algebra, or does it constitute a new structural property?
- (4) *Rigidity propagation beyond $N=5$* : Role-rigidity is forced at the minimum coexistence size $N=5$ under strong R (Theorem 4.8) but fails at $N=6, 7, 8$ under the same axioms (Proposition 4.9). What axiom strengthening beyond R+D+H with strong R uniformly forces role-rigidity at all sizes $N \geq 5$? Two natural candidates surface from the counterexamples: *classifier-nontriviality on core* (requiring $|\{\tau \cdot x : x \in \text{core}\}| \geq 2$, which rules out the $N=6$ counterexample), and *classifier boundary-discrimination* (requiring any two classifiers to disagree on at least one absorber input, which rules out the $N=8$ counterexample). Each is Z3-checkable for sufficiency at its problematic size; a uniform sufficient condition across all N remains open. A deeper question is whether the paper's three operational capabilities are fundamentally incomplete for pinning down a specific self-description at large N , or whether a single well-chosen additional axiom closes the gap.

Artifact. All Lean files, counterexample tables, and SAT reproduction scripts are available at <https://github.com/stefanopalmieri/finite-magma-independence>.

References

- [1] Brian Cantwell Smith. Reflection and semantics in Lisp. In *POPL*, pages 23–35, 1984.

- [2] Torben Mogensen. Efficient self-interpretation in lambda calculus. *Journal of Functional Programming*, 2(3):279–291, 1992.
- [3] Matt Brown and Jens Palsberg. Breaking through the normalization barrier: A self-interpreter for F-omega. In *POPL*, pages 5–17, 2016.
- [4] Saunders Mac Lane. *Categories for the Working Mathematician*. Springer, 1971.
- [5] Peter T. Johnstone. *Sketches of an Elephant: A Topos Theory Compendium*, vol. 1. Oxford University Press, 2002.
- [6] Leonid Libkin. *Elements of Finite Model Theory*. Springer, 2004.
- [7] Stanley Burris and H. P. Sankappanavar. *A Course in Universal Algebra*. Springer, 1981.
- [8] William McCune. *Prover9 and Mace4*. <https://www.cs.unm.edu/~mccune/prover9/>, 2005–2010.
- [9] Leonardo de Moura and Sebastian Ullrich. The Lean 4 theorem prover and programming language. In *CADE*, pages 625–635, 2021.
- [10] Jaap van Oosten. *Realizability: An Introduction to its Categorical Side*. Studies in Logic and the Foundations of Mathematics 152, Elsevier, 2008.
- [11] John Longley and Dag Normann. *Higher-Order Computability*. Theory and Applications of Computability, Springer, 2015.
- [12] Ingemarie Bethke. *Notes on Partial Combinatory Algebras*. PhD thesis, Universiteit van Amsterdam, 1988.
- [13] Ingemarie Bethke and Jan Willem Klop. Collapsing partial combinatory algebras. In *Higher-Order Algebra, Logic, and Term Rewriting (HOA 1995)*, LNCS 1074, pages 16–48, Springer, 1996. doi: 10.1007/3-540-61254-8_18.
- [14] J. Robin B. Cockett and Pieter Hofstra. Introduction to Turing categories. *Annals of Pure and Applied Logic*, 156(2–3):183–209, 2008. doi: 10.1016/j.apal.2008.04.005.

A Cayley Tables

All tables are extracted from the Lean source files and verified by lake build. Element i 's row is row i ; entry (i, j) is $i \cdot j$.

$N=4$: *Minimal R+D witness* ($s = r$). Roles: $0 = z_1, 1 = z_2, 2 = \tau, 3 = s = r$. Lean: CatKripkeWallMinimal.lean, kripke4.

$\cdot$	0	1	2	3
0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1
2	0	1	0	1
3	0	0	2	3

$N=5$: *Minimal R+D witness* ($s \neq r$). Roles: $0 = z_1, 1 = z_2, 2 = s, 3 = r, 4 = \tau$. Lean: CatKripkeWallMinimal.lean, kripke5.

$\cdot$	0	1	2	3	4
0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1
2	1	0	3	4	2
3	0	2	4	2	3
4	0	1	1	0	0

$N=5$: *R+D+H Optimal Coexistence* ($s = r$, minimal coexistence witness). Roles: $0 = z_1, 1 = z_2, 2 = s = r$ (identity on core, ICP b), $3 = \tau$ (classifier, ICP a), $4 = \tau_2$ (classifier, ICP c). Lean: Witness5.lean.

$\cdot$	0	1	2	3	4
0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1
2	0	2	2	3	4
3	0	0	0	1	0
4	0	1	0	1	0

$N=6$: *R+D+H Coexistence (role overlap)*. Roles: $0 = z_1, 1 = z_2, 2 = s$ (also ICP a), $3 = r$ (also ICP b), $4 = \tau, 5 = \text{ICP } c$. Lean: Witness6.lean.

·	0	1	2	3	4	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2	3	3	4	2	5	3
3	0	1	3	5	2	4
4	0	0	1	0	1	1
5	2	2	5	4	3	2

$N=8: R \not\Rightarrow D$ Counterexample. Roles: $0 = z_1, 1 = z_2, 2 = s, 3 = r, 4 = \text{classifier}, 5, 7 = \text{mixed (violate dichotomy)}$. Lean: Countermodel.lean.

·	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2	3	3	7	3	4	6	5	2
3	0	1	7	3	4	6	5	2
4	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0
5	6	2	6	2	1	1	1	1
6	0	0	5	2	2	2	2	2
7	2	2	2	1	2	2	6	3

$N=6: R \not\Rightarrow H$ Counterexample (structural). Roles: $0 = z_1, 1 = z_2, 2 = s = r$ (involution on core). Retraction pair holds; no triple satisfies ICP despite 4 core elements. Lean: E2PM.lean (sNoH6_e2pm).

·	0	1	2	3	4	5
0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2	0	3	3	2	5	4
3	2	4	5	5	1	4
4	5	3	0	0	3	2
5	4	2	2	2	2	2

$N=10: D \not\Rightarrow H$ Counterexample. Roles: $0 = z_1, 1 = z_2, 2 = s, 3 = r, 4 = \tau$. No triple satisfies ICP. Lean: Countermodels10.lean (dNotH), ICP.lean (dNotH_no_icp).

·	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2	3	3	2	3	4	5	6	7	9	8
3	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	9	8
4	0	0	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
5	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
6	2	3	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	8
7	3	2	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	8
8	1	0	1	0	1	1	1	1	0	0
9	0	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	1	1

$N=10: H \not\Rightarrow D$ Counterexample. Roles: $0 = z_1, 1 = z_2, 2 = s, 3 = r, 4 = \tau$. ICP holds ($a=8, b=6, c=7$). Element 5 violates dichotomy. Lean: Countermodels10.lean (hNotD).

·	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2	3	1	3	4	9	6	8	5	7	2
3	0	1	9	2	3	7	5	8	6	4
4	0	0	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	0
5	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	3	1
6	2	2	2	8	3	9	4	7	9	7
7	8	3	2	8	3	9	4	7	3	1
8	9	2	2	3	8	1	3	7	1	7
9	2	2	2	2	4	7	6	7	2	0

$N=4: D \not\Rightarrow R$ Counterexample (tight). Element 2 is a classifier: row on core is $(1, 1) \subseteq \{z_1, z_2\}$. Element 3 is a non-classifier: row on core is $(2, 2) \subseteq \text{core}$. No retraction pair exists among the 4 candidate

(s, r) assignments. Tight: D requires $N \geq 4$. Lean: E2PM.lean (d_not_implies_s_tight).

·	0	1	2	3
0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1
2	0	1	1	1
3	2	3	2	2

$N=5: H \not\Rightarrow R$ Counterexample (tight). ICP holds but no retraction pair exists. Tight: ICP requires $N \geq 5$. Lean: E2PM.lean (h_not_implies_s_tight).

·	0	1	2	3	4
0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1
2	3	1	0	3	1
3	2	4	3	4	2
4	2	2	1	0	3

$N=5: H \not\Rightarrow D$ Counterexample (tight). ICP holds but the dichotomy fails: no element maps core entirely to $\{z_1, z_2\}$ (no classifier exists). Tight: ICP requires $N \geq 5$. Lean: E2PM.lean (h_not_implies_d_tight).

·	0	1	2	3	4
0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1
2	3	3	4	3	3
3	2	4	4	4	3
4	2	2	2	4	4

$N=10: R+D+H$ Coexistence Witness (all roles distinct). $R+D+H$ roles: $0 = z_1, 1 = z_2, 2 = s, 3 = r, 4 = \tau, 8 = \eta$ (ICP a), $6 = g$ (ICP b , core-preserving), $7 = \rho$ (ICP c). Lean: Witness10.lean.

·	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2	3	3	4	3	7	5	9	6	8	2
3	0	1	9	3	2	5	7	4	8	6
4	0	0	1	1	1	0	0	0	1	1
5	2	2	7	2	8	9	4	3	4	2
6	0	0	6	4	8	7	3	3	4	9
7	2	2	6	4	8	9	4	3	4	9
8	2	2	4	8	4	3	4	4	8	9
9	3	4	7	3	9	2	2	9	2	3

B Proof Inventory

All Lean files compile with `lake build`, zero sorry. Proof styles: *Algebraic* = pure equational reasoning (no decide); *decide* = verified by kernel computation ($N \leq 8$); *native_decide* = verified by compiled native code ($N = 10$).

File	Thms	Style	Content
CatKripkeWallMinimal	20	Algebraic	Decomposition, bounds, wall
NoCommutativity	3	Algebraic	Asymmetry
Functoriality	4	Algebraic	Decomposition invariance
CapabilityInvariance	4	Algebraic	R, D, H each invariant
ICP	20	Alg.+decide	ICP $\Leftrightarrow$ Compose+Inert
Countermodel	5	decide	$R \not\Rightarrow D$ ($N=8$)
Countermodels10	9	native_dec.	$D \not\Rightarrow H, H \not\Rightarrow D$
E2PM	19	decide	$D \not\Rightarrow R, R \not\Rightarrow H, H \not\Rightarrow D, R \not\Rightarrow H$ (ti)
Witness10	6	native_dec.	$R+D+H$ at $N=10$
Witness5	3	decide	$R+D+H$ at $N=5$, no ICP at $N=4$
Witness6	3	decide	$R+D+H$ at $N=6$
BooleanCube	25	decide+nat.	Joint irredundance: all 8 cells of $(R,$
Total	121		